	harvested grains to the market, which in turn fueled an upward trend in the price of beans and only gradual reductions in the price of maize in October. This trend has now reversed.	stage or during the period in which beans are left in the field to dry, as a result of excessive rainfall in the production areas of Jinotega, Nueva Segovia, Matagalpa, and the Atlantic Autonomous Regions.
EL SALVADOR	Delayed decrease in the price of beans, despite imports and supply from production areas in neighboring countries, together with a slight decrease in maize prices.	Prices at year-end are likely to stabilize as a result of imports from a number of countries.

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Agricultural Production

Initial forecasts of an early end to the rainy season, which could have affected the region's *Postrera* crops, did not materialize. To the contrary, rainfall in some areas of the region was above-average (see figure) with good distribution, to the benefit of crop development. According to the weather outlook for Central America for the period between December 2014 and March 2015, as published by the XLV Central American Climate Outlook Forum, rainfall accumulation during the period will be normal, trending to above-average for the Atlantic coastal region and to below-average for areas along the Pacific coast. This will contribute to the normal development of the region's *Late Postrera* and *Apante* crops, which are sown primarily in the Atlantic coastal region, which will help compensate for the production losses of *Primera* crops. It is expected that this will lead to the stabilization of staple food prices by the conclusion of the first quarter of 2015.

HONDURAS: The Honduran government, through the Ministry of Agriculture and Livestock (SAG), has implemented a number of strategies for increasing the production of *Postrera* cycle bean crops. These strategies include the Honduran Agro-Food Sector Reactivation Fund (Fondo para la Reactivación del Sector Agroalimentario de Honduras – FIRSA); the trust fund for providing loans to bean producers for the access to inputs; the Farm Bonus for a Better Life (Bono Agrícola para una Vida Mejor) program, which provides improved seed; and a guaranteed price (one thousand lempiras per quintal) through the Honduran Agricultural Marketing Institute (Instituto Hondureño de Mercadeo Agrícola), with the latter available to production areas in Olancho, Yoro and El Paraíso.